Alternate Benefit

In some cases, you and your dental practitioner have a choice of treatment options. In an effort to keep your dental premiums affordable and assure you have coverage for the most common types of dental treatment, the dental plan limits benefits to the maximum allowable charge for the least costly covered service that accomplishes a result that meets accepted standards of professional dental care as determined by us.

If you or your dental practitioner should choose a more costly treatment or service, we will limit benefits payable to the benefit that would have been payable if the least costly covered service had been provided. This is called the alternate benefit. Any difference between the alternate benefit and the charge actually incurred is your responsibility, including any applicable coinsurance. In Section 5, services listed with an asterisk (*) often have the choice of a lower cost treatment. If you or your dental provider should choose this treatment or service, we will allow the lower cost alternative benefit unless evidence is submitted with the bill to explain why the less expensive treatment could not be done.

We decide the alternative benefit for covered services when we receive the claim. To avoid incurring expenses we will not cover, we encourage you to request a pre-determination of benefits before treatment begins.

Dental Review

Some services require additional information in order to determine if the services are covered or subject to an alternative benefit. The tooth number is required with claim submission to avoid claim processing delays. Radiographic images are required for crowns, periodontal procedures, inlays/onlays, anterior and multiple restorations, crown build-ups and implants. The complete treatment plan is also needed for implants. Charting is required for periodontal procedures. The date (month and year) of prior placement is required for replacement dentures, partials, crowns and bridges. The degree and classification of malocclusion is required for orthodontics.

Crown – A pre-operative bitewing and periapical radiographs are required to determine if services meet benefit guidelines for coverage. Date (month and year) of any prior crown is required, if replacement.

Implant – Radiographic images of full arch or panoramic radiographic image are required for implants along with the treatment plan for replacing all missing teeth and teeth that require extraction. Date (month and year) of any prior prosthesis replacing tooth/teeth to be replaced with implant(s).

Orthodontics – The degree and classification of malocclusion is required for orthodontics as follows:

- Classification of malocclusion (this means Class I, II, III), including narrative
- Degree of overjet, in mm
- Degree of overbite, in mm
- Anterior crowding discrepancy in mm
- Anterior spacing discrepancy in mm
- Description, if any, of cross bite
- Total number of months required for treatment
- Treatment objective
- Cephalometric image or tracing, if available
- Panoramic radiographic image
- Diagnostic photos

Periodontal – Full mouth or panoramic radiographs including current bitewing radiographs, periodontal charting, provider narrative and any additional diagnostic information necessary to determine if services meet benefit guidelines for coverage.

By submitting this information with your claim, you may avoid claim processing delays.